

Carlos Sebastián Castañeda

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SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 10+ years building production systems across FinTech, crypto, government, and health-tech, now focused on bringing AI-augmented engineering into backend and full-stack delivery. Strong foundation in Python (Django, FastAPI), AWS, and Docker, combined with hands-on use of AI coding assistants (Claude, OpenCode) and a growing focus on AI engineering — including applied coursework and a spec-driven development project built with Speckit. Full ownership of features from system architecture and payment integrations to frontend delivery, security remediation, and cross-functional collaboration with Product, Security, and DevOps. Looking to contribute in a senior engineering or technical lead role at the intersection of robust distributed systems and AI-first development.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer | XAPO Bank | May 2021 - February 2026

- Architected and shipped integrations with multiple FIAT and crypto payment providers using Python and AWS, enabling secure transaction processing for 10K+ customers.
- Used GitHub Copilot as an additional PR reviewer alongside other AI coding assistants, following the engineering org's adoption of the tool — regularly surfaced issues and code improvements missed in initial human review.
- Built and deployed internal automation tools that reduced manual operations by around ~50%, streamlining processing workflows across banking operations.
- Owned the security alert pipeline for the team — reviewing and remediating dependency vulnerabilities, enforcing secret scanning, and preventing sensitive data leaks in version control and application logs.
- Drove cross-team delivery with Product, Security, and DevOps — scoping requirements, defining technical solutions, and shipping high-availability services using AWS and Terraform.
- Mentored new engineers during onboarding, providing guidance on codebase architecture, development workflows, and team practices to accelerate ramp-up time.
- Participated in on-call rotations, triaging and resolving production incidents to ensure high availability of critical banking and payment services.

Senior Software Engineer | AccelOne LLC | March 2018 - May 2021

- Developed internal tooling for XAPO Bank (as external consultant) using Python, Flask, and MongoDB, supporting operational workflows for high-volume FIAT and cryptocurrency transaction processing.
- Designed and built a REST API using Node.js for a health-tech mobile application to track and manage medical procedure data, deployed on AWS.
- Owned end-to-end delivery across multiple client projects simultaneously, adapting to different tech stacks (Python/Flask, Node.js), codebases, and team workflows.

Software Engineer | DevsAr SA / Matterport | October 2017 - March 2018

- Built and enhanced features for Matterport's customer-facing web portal using Python (Django) on the backend and JavaScript on the frontend, working on-site with the engineering team in San Francisco, CA.
- Implemented a 3D model cloning feature in the customer portal, allowing users to duplicate and manage spatial models directly from the web interface.
- Contributed to performance monitoring and debugging using Datadog, improving visibility into application health and page load times.

Software Engineer | DevsAr SA / Moni (FinTech - Short-Term Credit Platform) | April 2016 - September 2017

- Shipped customer-facing features for a high-traffic payday loan platform serving 5K+ users, built with Python (Django, Celery) on the backend and JavaScript (Marionette) on the frontend.
- Enhanced the internal operations dashboard, improving loan management workflows and giving the operations team better visibility into portfolio health and borrower status.
- Partnered with Product to scope and prioritize new features, translating business requirements into technical specs for both the borrower-facing portal and back-office tooling.

Software Engineer | LIFIA - UNLP / Tesorería General de la Provincia de Bs. As. | August 2011 - April 2016

- Led the refactoring and modernization of a legacy government treasury system (CUT project) built on Java (5–7), Spring, JBoss, and Oracle Database, adapting system to meet the institution's evolving operational needs.
- Defined infrastructure requirements for the Oracle OS and JBoss application server environment alongside the DevOps team, and coordinated feature scoping across multiple government stakeholders.
- Documented system architecture and technical processes, supporting knowledge transfer within the development team and across institutional stakeholders.

EDUCATION

Computer Graphics, Images and Computer Vision Specialist [M.Sc.] | Universidad Nacional de la Plata, Postgrado - Facultad de Informática - UNLP | Argentina | 2017

- Thesis: Low cost home video surveillance system using instant messaging and image processing
- Advisor: Dra. Maria Jose Abasolo

Licenciado [B.Sc.] en Informática | Universidad Nacional de la Plata, Facultad de Informática - UNLP | Argentina | 2010

- Thesis: Test driven development applied to Rich Internet Applications.
- Advisor: Dr. Gustavo Rossi

Analista de Computación | Universidad Nacional de la Plata, Facultad de Informática - UNLP | Argentina | 2004

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate | Amazon Web Services Training and Certification | 2026

- Comprehensive understanding of AWS services and technologies.
- Demonstrated the ability to build secure and robust solutions using architectural design principles based on customer requirements.
- Ability to strategically design well-architected distributed systems that are scalable, resilient, efficient, and fault-tolerant.

Staff Engineer Bootcamp | turegano.net | 2026

- An intensive, practical bootcamp for aspiring or active Staff Engineers and Tech Leads who want to boost their careers.

SKILLS

Languages: Native Or Bilingual Proficiency in Spanish, Full Professional Proficiency in English

Soft Skills: Cross-functional Communication, Team Alignment and Collaboration, Critical Thinking, Adaptability, Problem-solving, Teamwork, Detail-oriented

Technical Skills:

AI engineering: Claude Code, Codex, Gemini, OpenCode, Gemini Notebook, GitHub Copilot

AI Engineering Practices: Spec Driven Development, spec-kit, OpenSpec

Methodologies: Agile, TDD, DDD

Programming languages: Python, JavaScript, Typescript, Java, C#, Bash

Frameworks & libraries: Django, FastAPI, Flask, Celery, Spring, Spring Boot, Node.js, OAuth2 and OpenID, Astro

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, SQLite

Cloud & infrastructure: AWS, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, Kafka

Observability & monitoring: New Relic, Datadog, Coralogix, Sentry, AWS CloudWatch, PagerDuty

CI/CD & version control: Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD pipelines

Tools & collaboration: Postman, JIRA, Confluence, Miro, Figma

Operating systems: Linux, macOS, Windows